

The Finance Committee
Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, Massachusetts 01027

Minutes of the Meeting

Monday April 27, 2026

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:03 P.M.

Present for Finance Committee: Tad Weiss (Chair), Jennifer Milikowsky (Fincom and SB), Jon Albitz, Maureen Dempsey (note-taker), Steve Holt, Scott Stanton, Jeremy Durrin

Also attending Select Board members: Scott Johndron, Chair Susan Bronstein, Police Chief Dave White, Sergeant Jeff Fish, Fire Chief Dave Antosz, Highway Superintendent Bill Jablonski, Cemetery Commission Chair John Shaw, Mike Diggins, Brad Morse, Ryan Brooks, Jeff Brooks

Review of Minutes

Motion to approve minutes made by Durrin, seconded by Dempsey.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 7-0-0

Discussion

Tad gave an overview of the current budget deficit:

\$330,00 deficit after cuts

\$45,000 unapproved revenue from Elementary School revolving fund

leaving \$285,000 as current deficit

Department Heads addressed the line items of their budgets that finance needed input on:

Police Dept. - \$58,962 adjusted for COLA is \$61,588 for Sergeant and 1 patrol officer at current hours. Chief Salary of \$40,063 remains the same.

Police cruiser at \$75,000 is on the warrant for Annual Town Meeting with an appropriation out of Free Cash. Chief White pointed out that it is on the Capital Schedule for this year and he is concerned about repair costs on the current vehicle. Tad suggested that the only way to pay for it would be out of the Stabilization Fund.

Fire Dept. - EMS coordinator does all the training for first responders. Without this position, the fire dept. would have to go outside for training at \$100 per volunteer and this would not cover other responsibilities of the position. Chief Antosz agreed that they could accept the reduction of the Emergency Management Service line item to \$6000. Chief Antosz mentioned that equipment cost keep going up. He received \$10,500 in grant money that only paid for new gear for 3 firefighters. He did not have an exact number but said that the town receives many hours of volunteer service from the department.

Highway Dept. - The reduction to \$11,500 on the **Administration** line item would put training of staff at risk. The **Highway Salaries** line item was discussed and the need to retain the 4th crew member was discussed at length. Bill emphasized the difficulties they would experience without this replacement. Suggestions were made to hire part-time people or hire someone to mow the cemetery. Bill also discussed

how additional paperwork for Chapter 90 and grant applications support the need of the **Highway Clerk** position. **Highway Materials, Road Machinery and Road Machinery Buildings** line items were discussed.

Town Administrator and Town Clerk line items were discussed with no motions made.

Reserve Fund line item was left at \$25,000 with a reminder from Doug that it cannot be used to “back fund” budgets. It is only for unanticipated expenses.

Following Dept head discussions, Tad made the suggestion that we ask the Elementary School to take an additional \$35,000 from savings and split the remaining deficit into a \$125,000 override and \$125,000 from Free Cash. Others on the committee felt we should split the \$35,000 cuts in other ways.

After much more discussion on how to address an override, it was suggested that we think about the following:

- \$10,000 from **Highway Materials** line item
- \$10,000 from the **Highway Clerk** line item
- \$15,000 from the **Elementary School**
- \$125,000 from Free Cash
- \$125,000 from an Override

This would cover the \$285,000 deficit in the budget. No votes were taken on this and final decisions will need to be made over the next week, including Fincom votes in warrant articles.

Selectboard voted to increase salary and stipends by a 2.5% COLA.

Steve Holt left the meeting at 9:30pm.

Next Meeting – Wednesday April 29 at 7:00 P.M.

Motion to Adjourn by Weiss seconded by Durrin at 9:50 P.M.

VOTE TO APPROVE: 6-0-0